

UNIT 5 / Time and daily life

Things you enjoy

Your goal: Talk about hobbies using gern and basic ability expressions.

01 Learn the idea

Gern follows an activity to express liking it: Ich lese gern means I like reading. It is not an adjective describing the activity. Use nicht gern for an activity you do not enjoy. Useful hobbies include lesen, schwimmen, kochen, tanzen and Fußball spielen.

Some common verbs change in the present: ich lese but du liest and er liest. Ich schwimme follows the regular pattern. Ask Was machst du gern? to invite a longer answer. You can name two hobbies with und and contrast preferences with aber, keeping complete simple clauses on each side.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich lese gern.	I like reading.
Ich schwimme gern.	I like swimming.
Ich koche nicht gern.	I do not like cooking.
Was machst du gern?	What do you like doing?
Wir spielen Fußball.	We play football.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Was machst du gern?

What do you like doing?

Mia

Ich lese gern und ich schwimme gern.

I like reading and I like swimming.

Ben

Kochst du auch gern?

Do you like cooking too?

Mia

Nein, ich koche nicht gern.

No, I do not like cooking.

Your real-life mission

Make a likes-and-dislikes list with four activities. Turn it into sentences using gern and nicht gern and ask a friend the hobby question.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich lese gern.” mean?

- A. I like swimming.
- B. I do not like cooking.
- C. I like reading.

2. What does “Ich schwimme gern.” mean?

- A. I like swimming.
- B. I do not like cooking.
- C. What do you like doing?

3. What does “Ich koche nicht gern.” mean?

- A. What do you like doing?
- B. I do not like cooking.
- C. We play football.

4. How do you say I like reading?

- A. Ich bin gern lesen.
- B. Ich lese gern.
- C. Ich gern lese.

5. Which activity does Mia not enjoy?

- A. Reading
- B. Swimming
- C. Cooking

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - I like reading.

“Ich lese gern.” means “I like reading.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - I like swimming.

“Ich schwimme gern.” means “I like swimming.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - I do not like cooking.

“Ich koche nicht gern.” means “I do not like cooking.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - Ich lese gern.

Use the conjugated activity verb lese followed by gern.

5. C - Cooking

Mia explicitly says Ich koche nicht gern.

One possible mission response

Ich lese gern. Ich schwimme gern. Ich tanze nicht gern. Ich koche nicht gern.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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